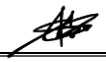
	Equipment Management	
	Document no: **ASMF 6.4 Proc**	
Compiled by:	**Tshepo Maponya - Laboratory Supervisor**	
Approved by:	**Nonhlanhla Msibi - Operations Manager**	

Table of Contents

1. Purpose & Scope 2

2. Selection and Verification 2

3. Identification and Labelling 2

4. Identification and Labelling 3

4. Handling, Transport, and Storage 4

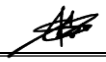
5. Calibration and Maintenance 4

6. Non-Conforming Equipment 4

7. Safeguarding 5

8. Use of external Equipment 5

9. Revision 5

AzurESky "ensure quality of test"	**Equipment Management**	
	Document no: ASMF 6.4 Proc	
Compiled by:	**Tshepo Maponya - Laboratory Supervisor**	
Approved by:	**Nonhlanhla Msibi - Operations Manager**	

1. Purpose & Scope

This procedure outlines the selection, identification, calibration, and maintenance of all laboratory equipment. This applies to all "critical equipment"—any hardware or software that can significantly influence the accuracy of laboratory results.

2. Selection and Verification

Before any equipment is placed into service (whether it is brand new or returning from repair), it must be verified.

- **Action:** The lab Manager/Supervisor compares the equipment's performance against the manufacturer's specifications or the laboratory's method requirements.
- **Record:** Identification & Verification results are noted in the **Equipment Register (ASMF 6.3 Equipment Register)**.

3. Mandated Service Providers

To ensure technical consistency and metrological traceability, the Laboratory mandates that all external service providers for equipment and software are selected, approved, and evaluated in accordance with the criteria defined in Checklist 6.6.3.

The process is structured as follows:

- Selection: Potential providers are identified and assessed against the requirements outlined in Checklist 6.6.3.
- Approval: Providers meeting the defined criteria are formally approved and documented.
- Evaluation: Approved providers are subject to periodic re-evaluation using the same checklist to ensure ongoing compliance and suitability.
- Register: All mandated and approved providers are recorded in the Externally Provided Products and Services Register (Section 6.6.3), which serves as the official record of compliance.

This ensures that the Laboratory's reliance on external providers is consistently controlled, traceable, and aligned with established quality management requirements.

Disclaimer: Management reserves the right to evaluate a service provider at any time during the stipulated period of validity if critical issues arise with the agreement in place. The lab can opt to use a new service provider even though the period of validity of the existing service providers is still in effect, with reasons provided in the checklist upon approval. The new service provider shall undergo the same process before approval.

3.1. Communication of Requirements

In accordance with ISO/IEC 17025 Clause 6.6.3, all technical and quality requirements are communicated to the provider via the signed checklist and supplementary purchase orders. This includes:

- **Technical Specifications:** Defined in the equipment table, including specific calibration setpoints and tolerances.
- **Acceptance Criteria:** Verification against the technical requirements of this procedure before equipment is commissioned.
- **Competence:** Mandatory requirement for **SANAS accreditation**, which in turn validates personnel competence as assigned technical signatories to their scope of activities listed in the accreditation certificate.
- **Access Rights:** The Laboratory reserves the right to witness activities at the provider's premises to verify compliance.

3.2. Ongoing Monitoring

The evaluator assesses the service provider annually; if no issues are found, the agreement with the service provider automatically rolls over to the next year. If issues arise during the review, a new service provider shall be evaluated the same way and approved for the services the lab requires when the criteria and competence requirements are met.

4. Identification and Labelling

All equipment listed in the register shall be uniquely identified with a dedicated equipment number.

- **Calibration Labels:** Equipment must be labelled with its calibration status, indicating the **date of last calibration** and the **due date for the next calibration,** where necessary.

4. Handling, Transport, and Storage

To prevent contamination, damage, or deterioration:

- Equipment must be used only by authorized personnel.
- Sensitive instruments (e.g., balances) must be protected from vibrations and extreme temperature shifts.
- If equipment is transported outside the lab, it must be re-verified upon return before being used for testing.

5. Calibration and Maintenance

- **Calibration Program:** The lab follows a schedule as defined in the **Equipment Register (ASMF 6.3 Equipment Register)**.
- **Service Providers:** Calibration is performed by accredited facilities (refer to **ASMF 6.2** for subcontracting/service provider assessment).
- **Intermediate Checks:** Where necessary (e.g., pH meters or scales), "intermediate checks" are performed between calibrations to maintain confidence in the equipment's status.

6. Non-Conforming Equipment

If equipment has been subjected to overloading, mishandling, gives suspect results, or is shown to be defective:

- **Isolate:** It must be taken out of service immediately.

- **Label:** A clear **"OUT OF SERVICE"** or **"DO NOT USE"** tag must be attached.
- **Investigate:** The lab must evaluate the impact of this defect on previous test results and initiate the non-conformance procedure if necessary.

7. Safeguarding

Equipment hardware and software shall be safeguarded from adjustments that would invalidate the test results. This includes password protection for software and physical seals on calibration-sensitive screws or knobs.

8. Use of external Equipment

The use of external equipment(borrowed/rented) shall be done in accordance with clause 6.4.2 of ISO 17025. Checklist ASMF 6.4.2 External Equipment Checklist shall be used to evaluate such equipment to make sure they adhere to the said clause (6.4.2) prior to them being introduced into the system. The records of the use of such equipment shall be kept and made available during internal/external assessments to ensure compliance.

9. Revision

Revision no	Content changed	Reason for revision
01	• Added section 8, which controls the use of external equipment. • Added a section that covers the mandating of the equipment service provider (section 3)	Ensure compliance to clause 6.4.2 of ISO 17025 Ensures compliance to subclause 6.6.3 of ISO 17025
02	• Refined the previously added section 8, and section 3	Ensures compliance to subclause 6.6.3 of ISO 17025